

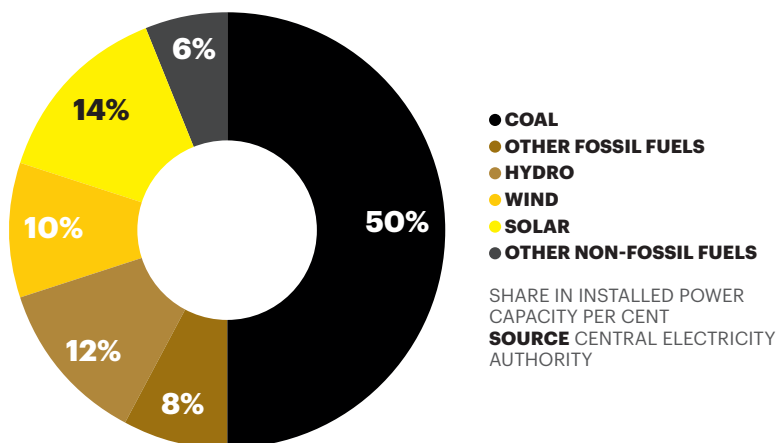
ery in global demand and the Russia-Ukraine conflict.

With an aim to reduce its oil import dependence, the central government intends to increase the country's exploration acreage to 0.5 million sq. km by 2025 and 1 million sq. km by 2030. The 99 per cent reduction in no-go areas or places where exploration activity was prohibited earlier has resulted in freeing up 0.91 million sq. km area for hydrocarbon exploration. "If you are 85 per cent import-dependent, you have to increase your exploration and production dramatically. We are setting up a National Data Repository (NDR) so that large companies can come and participate in energy exploration in the country's sedimentary basins," says Puri. Not just that, work is also underway on creating a cloud-based and artificial intelligence/machine learning (AI/ML)-powered NDR 2.0.

The government is also looking at augmenting blending of ethanol, made from sugarcane and other agri commodities in petrol. Plans are afoot to increase ethanol blending to 20 per cent by 2030, from the current level of 10.17 per cent. Besides, the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas has asked oil marketing companies Indian Oil Corporation, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation and Bharat Petroleum Corporation to start preparations for a switchover to green hydrogen from grey hydrogen for hydrodesulphurisation (a

THE SOURCE OF POWER

Conventional fuels like coal, lignite, gas and diesel account for nearly 60 per cent of India's total installed power capacity



THE TRANSITION TIGHTROPE

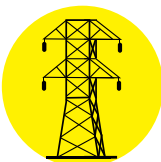
CHALLENGES

- ▶ Lack of reliable electricity supply for many consumers and a continued reliance on solid biomass, mainly firewood and charcoal, as cooking fuel
- ▶ Bottlenecks created by global supply-side issues have led to a surge in raw material and freight costs for solar equipment manufacturers
- ▶ Financial health of electricity distribution companies may notably slow down energy transformation in the country

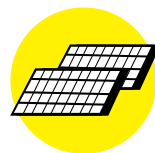
OPPORTUNITIES

- ▶ Over 93.4 million LPG connections released till July 2022 for BPL households under Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana for cooking
- ▶ PLI scheme for GW-scale manufacturing of high-efficiency photovoltaic cells and 40 per cent duty on imports from China to prevent dumping
- ▶ The Electricity (Amendment) Bill, 2022, seeking to bring about comprehensive reforms is currently under review by a parliamentary committee

▶ India has committed to net-zero emissions by 2070 and meeting 50 per cent of its electricity requirements from renewables by 2030



▶ India's renewable energy sector is growing at the fastest clip among all major world economies



▶ Globally, it is among the Top 5 players in installed solar capacity and one of the Top 3 renewable energy producers